



CITY COUNCIL MEETING MINUTES

April 29, 2025

CALL TO ORDER:

The Jackson City Council met in regular session in Council Chambers and was called to order at 6:30 p.m. by Mayor Daniel J. Mahoney.

PLEDGE OF ALLEGIANCE AND INVOCATION:

Council joined in the Pledge of Allegiance. Invocation was given by Vice Mayor/Second Ward Councilmember Freddie Dancy.

ROLL CALL:

Present: Mayor Daniel Mahoney, First Ward Councilmember Arlene Robinson, Vice Mayor/Second Ward Councilmember Freddie Dancy, Third Ward Councilmember Angelita Gunn, Fourth Ward Councilmember Conner Wood, Fifth Ward Councilmember Christy Davis, and Sixth Ward Councilmember Will Forgrave.

Absent: none.

Also present: City Manager Jonathan Greene, City Attorney Matthew Hagerty, City Clerk Andrea Muray, City Assessor Jason Yoakam, Chief Equity Officer John Willis, Police Chief Chris Simpson, Director of Community Development Shane LaPorte, and City Engineer Troy White.

ADOPTION OF AGENDA:

Motion was made by Councilmember Wood, seconded by Councilmember Robinson to adopt the agenda. Vote – Yeas: Mayor Mahoney, Vice Mayor Dancy, Councilmembers Robinson, Gunn, Wood, Davis, and Forgrave (7). Nays: none. Motion carried.

PRESENTATIONS/PROCLAMATIONS:

- A. Proclamation recognizing May 4, 2025 as National Firefighters Day in the City of Jackson

Mayor Mahoney presented Fire Chief Tim Gonzales with a proclamation declaring May 4, 2025 as National Firefighters Day in the City of Jackson.

- B. Drinking Water State Revolving Fund (DWSRF) Fiscal Year 2026 Water System Improvements Project Plan Presentation from Fishbeck.

Colin McCorkle from Fishbeck presented Council with the FY 2026 DWSRF Water System Improvements Project Plan.

PUBLIC HEARINGS:

- A. Citizen Comment on the sale of City-owned property - 414 N Jackson

Motion was made by Councilmember Wood, seconded by Councilmember Gunn to open the public hearing to receive citizen comment on the sale of the City-owned property located at 414 N Jackson. Vote was done by voice with all in favor. Motion carried.

Citizen comments were heard during the hearing.

Motion was made by Councilmember Wood, seconded by Councilmember Forgrave, to close the public hearing. Vote was done by voice with all in favor. Motion carried.

- B. Public Hearing - Final Project Plan for the City's application for the Drinking Water State Revolving Fund Loan

Motion was made by Councilmember Wood, seconded by Councilmember Gunn to open the public hearing for the final project plan for the City's application for the Drinking Water State Revolving Fund Loan. Vote was done by voice with all in favor. Motion carried.

Citizen comments were heard during the hearing,

Motion was made by Councilmember Wood, seconded by Councilmember Robinson, to close the public hearing. Vote was done by voice with all in favor. Motion carried.

Motion was made by Councilmember Wood, seconded by Councilmember Gunn, to adopt the resolution for the final project plan for water system improvement projects and designating an authorized project representative. Vote – Yeas: Mayor Mahoney, Vice Mayor Dancy, Councilmembers Robinson, Gunn, Wood, Davis, and Forgrave (7). Nays: none. Motion carried.

CITIZEN COMMENTS:

Citizen comments were heard and the meeting continued.

A motion was made by Vice Mayor Dancy, seconded by Mayor Mahoney to take a three minute recess. Vote was done by voice with all in favor. Motion carried.

The meeting was recessed from 8:04 p.m. until 8:14 p.m.

Motion was made by Councilmember Gunn, seconded by Vice Mayor Dancy to return. Vote was done by voice with all in favor. Motion carried.

CONSENT CALENDAR:

A. Meeting Minutes of the April 15, 2025, Regular Meeting of the Jackson City Council

Approve the minutes of the April 15, 2025 Regular Meeting of the Jackson City Council.

B. Resolution - Charitable Gaming Licenses for Michigan Military Heritage Museum

Approve a resolution recognizing Michigan Military Heritage Museum as a non-profit organization for the purpose of obtaining a charitable gaming license

C. Special Event Application: Relay for Life of Jackson County

Approve a request from the American Cancer Society to host the Relay for Life of Jackson County on August 1-2, 2025, at Cascades Park.

D. Special Event Application: Jackson High School Commencement Ceremony

Approve a request from the Jackson Public Schools to host the Jackson High School Commencement Ceremony on May 23, 2025, in downtown Jackson.

E. Special Event Application: Grand River Farmers Market

Approve a request from the Jackson Downtown Development Authority to host the Grand River Farmers Market on Fridays and Saturdays from May 2 to October 31, 2025, in downtown Jackson at the Grand River Pavilion.

F. Special Event Application: Grand River Farmers Market at Henry Ford

Approve a request from the Jackson Downtown Development Authority to host the Grand River Farmers Market at Henry Ford on Tuesdays, May 6 through October 28, 2025, in downtown Jackson.

G. Special Event Application: Free Community Pet Vaccines at Loomis Park

Approve a request from the Jackson County Animal Shelter to host the Free Community Pet Vaccines on May 19, 2025, at Loomis Park.

H. Special Event Application: May Cruise-In & Concert

Approve a request from the Jackson Downtown Development Authority to host the May Cruise-In & Concert on May 23, 2025, on the streets of downtown Jackson.

I. Special Event Application: Juneteenth

Approve a request from the Jackson Juneteenth Committee to host the Jackson Juneteenth Celebration on June 21, 2025, in downtown Jackson.

J. Special Event Application: Police Memorial

Approve a request from the City of Jackson Police Department to host the City of Jackson Police Officer Memorial on May 7, 2025, in downtown Jackson.

Motion was made by Councilmember Wood, seconded by Councilmember Gunn to approve the consent calendar. Vote – Yeas: Mayor Mahoney, Vice Mayor Dancy, Councilmembers Robinson, Gunn, Wood, Davis, and Forgrave (7). Nays: none. Motion carried.

OTHER BUSINESS:

A. East Side Economic Development Update

City Manager Jonathan Greene provided Council with an update on the status of the efforts being made to support economic development on the east side of the City.

NEW BUSINESS:

A. Change Order - Wastewater Treatment Plant and Myrtle Lift Station Improvements Contract

Recommendation: *Approve Change Order No. 3 to the Wastewater Treatment Plant and Myrtle Lift Station Improvements Contract with Allied Mechanical Services, Inc., and authorize the City Manager and Director of Public Works to execute the appropriate documents.*

Motion was made by Councilmember Wood, seconded by Councilmember Gunn to approve Change Order No. 3 to the Wastewater Treatment Plant and Myrtle Lift Station Improvements Contract with Allied Mechanical Services, Inc. and authorize the City Manager and Director of Public Works to execute the appropriate documents. Vote – Yeas: Mayor Mahoney, Vice Mayor Dancy, Councilmembers Robinson, Gunn, Wood, Davis, and Forgrave (7). Nays: none. Motion carried.

B. Assessor's Contract Renewal

Recommendation: *Approval of a three-year Professional Services Agreement in the amount of \$105,554.40 annually with Quality Assessing Services, LLC for assessment services starting May 1, 2025 through April 30, 2028.*

Motion was made by Councilmember Wood, seconded by Vice Mayor Dancy to approve a three-year Professional Services Agreement in the amount of \$105,554.40 annually with Quality Assessing Services, LLC for assessment services starting May 1, 2025 through April 30, 2028. Vote – Yeas: Mayor Mahoney, Vice Mayor Dancy, Councilmembers Robinson, Gunn, Wood, Davis, and Forgrave (7). Nays: none. Motion carried.

C. Ordinance Amendment - Chapter 28, Section 73 of the Zoning Ordinance

Recommendation: *Approve the first reading of a revision to the Zoning Ordinance, Chapter 28 Section 73, reducing lot width, lot size, and side yard setbacks in the R-1 zoning district.*

Motion was made by Vice Mayor Dancy, seconded by Councilmember Wood to approve the first reading of a revision to the Zoning Ordinance, Chapter 28 Section 73, reducing lot width, lot size, and side yard setbacks in the R-1 zoning district. Vote – Yeas: Mayor Mahoney, Vice Mayor Dancy, Councilmembers Robinson, Gunn, Wood, Davis, and Forgrave (7). Nays: none. Motion carried.

D. Marihuana License Stakeholder Amendment - SMOK/JARS

Recommendation: *Approve the stakeholder amendment for the Marihuana License held by SMOK/Jars, located at 810 W Argyle, as recommended by the Marihuana Licensing Review Committee.*

Motion was made by Councilmember Forgrave, seconded by Mayor Mahoney to approve the stakeholder amendment for the Marihuana License held by SMOK/Jars, located at 810 W Argyle, as recommended by the Marihuana Licensing Review Committee. Vote – Yeas: Mayor Mahoney, Councilmembers Robinson, Gunn, Wood, Davis, and Forgrave (6). Nays: Vice Mayor Dancy (1). Motion carried.

E. F/Y 2025/26 CDBG and HOME Projects and Final Funding Allocations

Recommendation: *Confirm Community Development Block Grant (CDBG) and HOME Investment Partnerships (HOME) Projects for Fiscal Year 2025 – 2026 and Establish Final Funding Allocations for those Projects.*

Motion was made by Councilmember Wood, seconded by Councilmember Gunn to confirm Community Development Block Grant and HOME Investment Partnerships Projects for Fiscal Year 2025 – 2026 and establish final funding allocations for those projects. Vote – Yeas: Mayor Mahoney, Vice Mayor Dancy, Councilmembers Robinson, Gunn, Wood, Davis, and Forgrave (7). Nays: none. Motion carried.

F. MICH-Grant Visitable Homes Construction Contract

Recommendation: *Approve the contract with Norfolk Homes of Michigan LLC for the construction of four (4) MICH homes, for the total amount of \$800,000; authorize the City Manager and City Attorney to make minor modifications as needed; authorize the City Manager to effectuate the sale and transfer of required lots to the recommended builder; and further authorize the City Manager to execute the appropriate documents necessary to complete these agreements.*

Motion was made by Vice Mayor Dancy, seconded by Councilmember Gunn to approve the contract with Norfolk Homes of Michigan LLC for the construction of four MICH homes, for the total amount of \$800,000; authorize the City Manager and City Attorney to make minor modifications as needed; authorize the City Manager to effectuate the sale and transfer of required lots to the recommended builder; and further authorize the City Manager to execute the appropriate documents necessary to complete these agreements. Vote – Yeas: Mayor Mahoney, Vice Mayor Dancy, Councilmembers Robinson, Gunn, Wood, Davis, and Forgrave (7). Nays: none. Motion carried.

CLOSED SESSION:

A. Conduct closed session pursuant to MCL 15.268(e) concerning Jackson County 4th Circuit Court Case No. 24-1977-NO

Motion was made by Councilmember Wood, seconded by Councilmember Gunn to enter closed session pursuant to MCL 15.268(e) concerning Jackson County 4th Circuit Court Case No. 24-1977-NO. Vote – Yeas: Mayor Mahoney, Vice Mayor Dancy, Councilmembers Robinson, Gunn, Wood, Davis, and Forgrave (7). Nays: none. Motion carried.

Motion was made by Councilmember Wood, seconded by Councilmember Robinson to return from closed session. Vote – Yeas: Mayor Mahoney, Vice Mayor Dancy, Councilmembers Robinson, Gunn, Wood, Davis, and Forgrave (7). Nays: none. Motion carried.

Motion was made by Councilmember Wood, seconded by Vice Mayor Dancy to approve the settlement as recommended by the City Attorney and Claims Counsel in the 4th Circuit Court Case No. 24-1977-NO, Bowman V. City of Jackson. Vote – Yeas: Mayor Mahoney, Vice Mayor Dancy, Councilmembers Robinson, Gunn, Wood, Davis, and Forgrave (7). Nays: none. Motion carried.

CITY COUNCILMEMBER’S COMMENTS:

Mayor Mahoney, Vice Mayor Dancy, and Councilmembers Robinson, Gunn, Wood, Davis, and Forgrave all offered comments.

MANAGER’S COMMENTS:

City Manager Jonathan Greene offered comments.

ADJOURNMENT:

No further business being offered, a motion to adjourn was made by Councilmember Wood, seconded by Vice Mayor Dancy. Vote was done by voice with all in favor. Mayor Mahoney adjourned the meeting at 9:22 p.m.